

Post-incident review PIR-2025-005

Customer Portal: intermittent timeouts

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 23 March 2025, Customer Portal experienced intermittent timeouts in production (Southeast Asia) for about 40 minutes. A latency threshold alert fired for the service's main endpoint. Investigation found that request volume during a marketing campaign exceeded the provisioned throughput.

Impact

Users of Customer Portal saw intermittent timeouts for about 40 minutes. The service owner, Digital Channels, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:12 First signal received.
- 09:36 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:45 Likely cause identified.
- 10:21 Mitigation applied.
- 10:48 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that request volume during a marketing campaign exceeded the provisioned throughput.

The rollback script had never been exercised and failed on first use.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Move certificate renewal into the automated rotation pipeline.
- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Write and rehearse a runbook for this failure mode.